

“ I HOPE IT WILL BE **HARD FOR THE RUSSIANS TO JUMP ACROSS THAT CREEK.** ”

Gustavus Adolphus, king of Sweden, Treaty of Stolbovo, 1617

THE SEEDS OF THE LATER FALL of China's Ming dynasty (see 1644) were sown in 1616 when Manchu tribal leader, Nurhaci (1559–1626), **pronounced himself Great Jin**, establishing the Qing dynasty.

20,000
THE NUMBER
OF **BLUE**
CEILING TILES
THAT GIVE THE
BLUE MOSQUE
ITS NAME

Since 1599, he had united other Manchu tribes in the **Eight Banners military system**. War with the Ming followed in 1618.

Although the Magellan Strait, linking **the Atlantic and Pacific** in southern South America, had been discovered in 1519, it was

difficult to navigate. In 1616, a **Dutch expedition** under Jakob le Maire and Willem Schouten found a new route through open water to the south, naming its southernmost island, **Cape Horn**.

One of **Islam's finest buildings** was completed after seven years in 1616. The Sultan Ahmed Mosque, in Constantinople (now Istanbul), is **known as the Blue Mosque** because of the many ceramic tiles of its interior.

Gorée Island, to the south of Africa's Cape Verde, was purchased by the Dutch from its Portuguese owners in 1617. They turned it into a **major slave trading base**, a role continued by the French, who took it in 1677.

The 1617 **Treaty of Stolbovo** ended the war between Russia and Sweden that had lasted seven years. It drew a new, more **secure boundary for Sweden** that made use of lakes Ladoga and Peipus.

Dutch slave base

This colored engraving shows the fort at Gorée Island when it was controlled by the Dutch. It proved a highly profitable venture for them.



An illustration depicts the defenestration of two regents by Protestants in Prague Castle, Bohemia, an event that sparked the Thirty Years' War.

“ THIS IS A **SHARP MEDICINE**, BUT IT IS A **PHYSICIAN FOR ALL DISEASES AND MISERIES.** ”

Sir Walter Raleigh, last words before execution, October 29, 1618

ON MAY 23, 1618, THE PROTESTANT Count Thurn had the two regents of the Catholic king of Bohemia, and future Holy Roman Emperor, Ferdinand II (1578–1637), thrown from an upper window of Prague Castle, in Bohemia. The **Defenestration of Prague** sparked the brutal **Thirty Years' War**. It was mostly confined to Germany, which by 1648 was a scene of wholesale destruction and slaughter. Initially a religious conflict, **Ferdinand's quest to erase Protestantism** from all his dominions became a Europe-wide fight for supremacy involving, at different points, every major European power.

On October 29, 1618, the English soldier and explorer **Sir Walter Raleigh** (1552–1618) was **executed by beheading** at the Tower of London. He had been one of the early English colonizers of Virginia, North America, but his failure to find the legendary South American **city of El Dorado**, as well as his attacking a Spanish settlement against the expressed wishes of King James I, had sealed his fate.

English privateers (state-sponsored raiders) had bought and sold **African slaves** since the late 16th century, but in 1618 England's involvement in the Atlantic slave trade became deeper when the **first slave shipment to its North American colonies** arrived from West Africa at Jamestown, Virginia.

EARLY SLAVE TRADE

Although it was in the 18th century that the Atlantic slave trade reached its peak, in the early 17th century it was developing rapidly. Slaves were transported from a series of slave forts on the west coast of Africa to the burgeoning European colonial lands of the New World. Male slaves were branded with irons (pictured) on the Atlantic Ocean crossing, in which about 25 percent died.



The work of the English philosopher Francis Bacon was to have a lasting impact.

THE DUTCH, IN AGGRESSIVELY SEEKING to supplant the Portuguese in the **East Indies**, had first attempted to establish a **trading post in Java** in 1596. From 1602, they also had to contend with English efforts to infiltrate themselves in the East Indies. In 1619, the **Dutch struck back** decisively, ousting the English and their Javanese allies, and establishing themselves in Jayakarta, which they **renamed Batavia**. It would become not merely the **capital of the Dutch East Indies** but the focal point of the Dutch colonial empire, dismembered only by its conquest by Japan in 1942.



January 1616
Dutch discover route around Cape Horn

April 23, 1616
Spanish writer Miguel de Cervantes dies (b. 1547)

April 23, 1616
English playwright William Shakespeare dies (b. 1564)

February 27, 1617
Treaty of Stolbovo ends Ingrian War between Sweden and Russia

1616 Blue Mosque, in Constantinople, completed

1617 Gorée Island, south of Cape Verde, Africa, becomes a Dutch possession

March 21, 1617
Algonquian Indian princess Pocahontas dies (b.c. 1595)

May 23
Defenestration of Prague sparks Thirty Years' War

October 29
English adventurer and courtier Sir Walter Raleigh executed (b. 1552)

First African slaves shipped to English American colonies arrive in Jamestown, Virginia

Ottomans recognize the reconquest of Persia by Shah Abbas

Nurhaci's Seven Grievances declaration of war on Ming

German astronomer Johannes Kepler (1571–1630) discovers **third law of planetary motion**

November 3
Mughal emperor Aurangzeb born (d. 1707)

March 1619
Qing defeat Ming at Battle of Sarhu

March 6, 1619
French poet Cyrano de Bergerac born (d. 1655)

1619 Treaty of Deulino ends Polish–Russian War

May 30, 1619
Dutch found Batavia, Java

May 8, 1619
Synod of Dort, Netherlands, endorses hardline Calvinist theology